Question ID: ac472881

Assessment	Test	Domain	Skill	Difficulty
SAT	Math	Algebra	Linear equations in one variable	Hard

Question

$$\frac{12x+28}{4} - \frac{s}{13} = r(x-8)$$

In the given equation, s and r are constants, and $s > 0$. If the equation has infinitely many solutions, what is the value of s?

Correct Answer: 403

Rationale

The correct answer is 403. For a linear equation in one variable to have infinitely many solutions, the coefficients of the variable must be equal on both sides of the equation and the constant terms must also be equal on both sides of the equation. The given equation can be rewritten as $\frac{4(3x+7)}{4} - \frac{s}{13} = r(x-8)$, or $3x + 7 - \frac{s}{13} = r(x-8)$. Applying the distributive property to the right-hand side of this equation yields $3x + 7 - \frac{s}{13} = rx - 8r$. For this equation to have infinitely many solutions, the coefficients of x must be equal, so it follows that $3 = r$. Additionally, the constant terms must be equal, which means $7 - \frac{s}{13} = -8r$. Substituting 3 for r in this equation yields $7 - \frac{s}{13} = -8(3)$, or $7 - \frac{s}{13} = -24$. Adding $\frac{s}{13}$ to both sides of this equation yields $7 = -24 + \frac{s}{13}$. Adding 24 to both sides of this equation yields $31 = \frac{s}{13}$. Multiplying both sides of this equation by 13 yields $403 = s$. Therefore, if the equation has infinitely many solutions, the value of s is 403.